

University of Exeter

Logic Lab

15th October 2026



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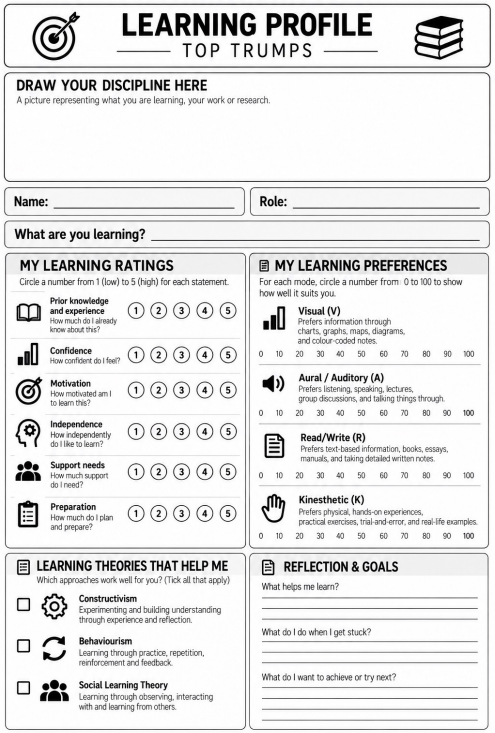
How Do You Learn?

Overview

Theory



Activity:
Create your own Top Trump Card



LEARNING PROFILE
TOP TRUMPS

DRAW YOUR DISCIPLINE HERE
A picture representing what you are learning, your work or research.

Name: _____ Role: _____

What are you learning? _____

MY LEARNING RATINGS
Circle a number from 1 (low) to 5 (high) for each statement.

- Prior knowledge and experience — How much do I already know about this? (1 2 3 4 5)
- Confidence — How confident do I feel? (1 2 3 4 5)
- Motivation — How motivated am I to learn this? (1 2 3 4 5)
- Independence — How independently do I like to learn? (1 2 3 4 5)
- Support needs — How much support do I need? (1 2 3 4 5)
- Preparation — How much do I plan and prepare? (1 2 3 4 5)

MY LEARNING PREFERENCES
For each mode, circle a number from 0 to 100 to show how well it suits you.

- Visual (V) — Prefers information through charts, graphs, maps, diagrams, and colour-coded notes. 0 10 20 30 40 50 60 70 80 90 100
- Aural / Auditory (A) — Prefers listening, speaking, lectures, group discussions, and talking things through. 0 10 20 30 40 50 60 70 80 90 100
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LEARNING THEORIES THAT HELP ME
Which approaches work well for you? (Tick all that apply)

- ☐ Constructivism — Experimenting and building understanding through experience and reflection.
- ☐ Behaviourism — Learning through practice, repetition, reinforcement and feedback.
- ☐ Social Learning Theory — Learning through observing, interacting with and learning from others.

REFLECTION & GOALS

What helps me learn?

What do I do when I get stuck?

What do I want to achieve or try next?

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What are Learner Profiles?

Learner profiles describe the characteristics, experiences, motivations and preferences that influence how individuals learn

Cognitive Abilities



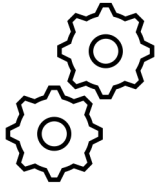
Prior Knowledge and Experience



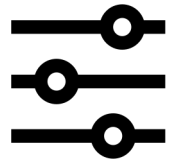
Cultural and Linguistic Background



Interests and Motivations



Learning Preferences



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Learning Preferences

Learning preferences are one component of a learner profile

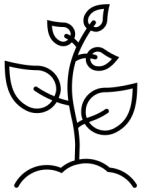
- Learning Preferences as Desire Paths



Image Credit: By dankeck - https://www.flickr.com/photos/140641142@N05/52849400711/, CC0, https://commons.wikimedia.org/w/index.php?curid=131970058

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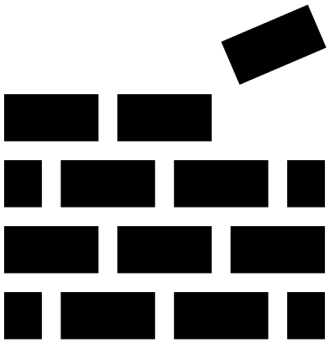
Stages of Learning

Novice	Advanced Beginner	Competent	Proficient	Expert
				

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Overview of Learning Theories

Constructivism



Behaviourism



Social Learning Theory



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Andragogy (Adult Learning Theory)

Andragogy refers to method and practice of teaching adult learners.

Self-Directed



Experiences Based



Readiness to Learn



Intrinsic Motivation



Practical Application



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Metacognition – Thinking about thinking

Planning

How do I approach learning something unfamiliar?



Monitoring

How do I recognise whether I'm understanding it?



Evaluating

How do I know what worked and what I should change?



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What makes you the learner you are?

Think about a skill you're currently learning, or something you've recently tried to learn.

Prior Experience



Confidence



Motivation



Independence



Support Needs



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NOTE: Your learner profile is not fixed, it changes with experience, context and the skills you're learning

Create Your Top Trump Card

LEARNING PROFILE
TOP TRUMPS

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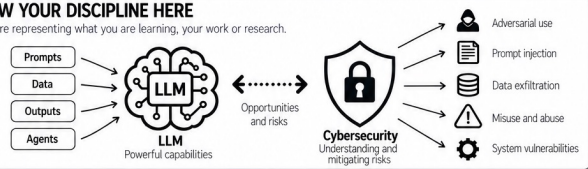
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What do I want to achieve or try next?

LEARNING PROFILE
TOP TRUMPS

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Name: Liam Berrisford **Role:** Research Software Engineer

What are you learning? LLM Cybersecurity

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Confidence	How confident do I feel?	1 2 **3** 4 5
Motivation	How motivated am I to learn this?	1 2 3 4 **5**
Independence	(self-directed) How independently do I like to learn?	1 2 3 **4** 5
Support needs	How much support do I need?	1 **2** 3 4 5
Preparation	(how much I plan) How much do I plan and prepare?	**1** 2 3 4 5

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REFLECTION & GOALS
What helps me learn?
I learn best by breaking things, experimenting, and exploring real-world examples. I find visual resources (diagrams, workflows) and reading in depth very helpful. I also benefit from trying things hands-on and seeing how they work in practice.

What do I do when I get stuck?
Break the problem down, search documentation, experiment with different approaches, and ask colleagues or the community.

What do I want to achieve or try next?
To be able to understand how LLMs can be warped outside of what their initial intentions were, including potential misuse, exploitation and real-world attack scenarios.